

URBAN WATER TRANSPORTATION UNDER SAGARMALA

A Decade of Reshaping Lives

"Smooth sailing to Mandwa! Exceptional assistance for seniors and top-notch wheelchair accessibility."
NISHA KHOT

"Unbelievable experience! Affordable luxury with cleanliness and hygiene as top priorities. Pet-friendly too!"
KANAK KANGAVKAR

"Efficient service for transporting vehicles between Mumbai and Alibaug. Safe, prompt, and courteous staff."
ARUNAVA PRAMANICK

"A fantastic addition to Mumbai's attractions. Speedy travel, well-designed ferries, and delicious food make for a memorable journey."
K. V RAJESH

These testimonials highlight the **success of the innovative and eco-friendly Urban Water Transportation system** implemented through Ro-Ro/Ro-Pax Ferries. In the bustling urban centers of India, where **traffic jams and congestion** have become synonymous with daily life, a silent revolution has been taking place on the country's waterways. The **Sagarmala Programme**, initiated by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways (MoPSW), has been quietly transforming urban transportation through funding requisite infrastructure required for its innovative Ro-Ro/Ro-Pax ferry services. Let us delve into the remarkable journey of **Sagarmala's Urban Water Transportation** initiatives, and its impact on **commuters, the environment, and economic development**.

Launched in **2015**, the Sagarmala Programme set out with a **bold vision:** to accelerate **economic development** and **promote self-reliance** (Aatmanirbhar Bharat) by harnessing India's vast coastline and navigable waterways. With **over 7,500 kilometers** of coastline and **14,500 kilometers** of potentially navigable waterways, India possessed immense untapped potential in maritime transportation. The programme aimed to leverage this strategic advantage to propel India's growth on the global stage. Over the years, Sagarmala has evolved into a multifaceted initiative, encompassing **over 830 projects** with a cumulative investment **exceeding Rs 5.70 Lakh Crore.** These projects span various sectors, including **port modernization, connectivity enhancement, coastal community development,** and crucially, **urban water transportation**. At its core, Sagarmala seeks to optimize maritime infrastructure to drive **economic prosperity** while fostering **sustainability and inclusivity.**

Urban water transportation, facilitated by **Roll-on-Roll-off (RORO)** and **Roll-on-Passenger (ROPAX)** services alongside Passenger Jetties, presents significant advantages, notably decreased travel time, reduced emissions, and alleviated road congestion. Acknowledging India's extensive coastline and river connectivity, MoPSW under its **Sagarmala** Programme has initiated **63 projects** across 57 locations with a total investment of **Rs. 2,065 Cr.** Of these, **10 projects** amounting to **Rs. 527 Cr.** at 07 locations have already been **completed**. Notably, operational terminals exist in **Hazira (Gujarat), Mandwa, Kanhoji Angre Island, and Belapur (Maharashtra)**. Maharashtra's operational terminals have opened up routes to **Elephanta Islands, Navi Mumbai, JNPA, and DCT Mumbai.** The implementation of Ro-Pax and Passenger ferry services has significantly **slashed travel durations,** for instance, reducing travel time on routes such as Mumbai-Mandwa from **3 hrs to 45 mins,** Belapur-Elephanta Island from 2.15 hrs to 30 mins, Belapur-JNPA from 45 mins to 30 mins, Belapur-Mumbai from **1.30 hrs to 20 mins**, Belapur-Mandwa from 2 hrs to 45 mins, and Hazira-Ghogha from **10 hrs to 4 hrs**. These services have catered to **over 30 lakh passengers**, transported more than **5 lakh passenger vehicles,** and facilitated the movement of **over 1 lakh cargo-carrying trucks**, resulting in a saving of **over 2 crore liters of fuel** and nearly **44 MT of carbon emissions**. Moreover, these initiatives have stimulated tourism in the region, with activities such as **bird watching (including flamingos)** and **water sports** gaining traction.

As Sagarmala continues to chart new horizons towards creation of a robust Urban Water Transportation Ecosystem, the future holds boundless opportunities for innovation and growth as MoPSW via its Sagarmala Programme remains steadfast in its mission to propel India towards a brighter, more prosperous future. In the annals of India's maritime history, Sagarmala's urban water transportation initiatives will undoubtedly stand as a testament to the power of vision, innovation, and collaboration.

By harnessing the potential of India's vast coastline and waterways, Sagarmala has not only transformed urban commutes but has also paved the way for a **more sustainable, connected, and resilient future.** As we sail towards new horizons, MoPSW under the visionary leadership of **Sh. Narendra Modi, Hon'ble Prime Minister** and spearheaded by **Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal, Hon'ble Union Minister-MoPSW & AYUSH** is committed to **embrace the spirit of Sagarmala** and chart a course towards **prosperity for all.**